

Those programs have become a form of “middle-class welfare,” says Samuelson; they must be cut.

THE FAMILY OFFICE

We are not complaining. Nor do we believe in trying to change the course of history. We are not world improvers. Still, we do our best to improve our own lives and those of our heirs and descendants.

Three or four years ago, we began to think seriously about what to do with our own money. What was the plan? Spend it? Save it? Forget about it and hope for the best?

What was the plan for the children? What would become of them if something happened to their parents? Would they be able to “make it” on their own? What if something went wrong? Should they depend on the charity of the state or the planning and preparations of their own father and mother?

It was about that time that we discovered the concept of the “family office.” Poor people have food stamps and bail bonds. The middle class has Social Security and Medicaid. Rich people have family offices.

When we say “rich people,” we’re not talking about those who win the lottery or a million-dollar contract to play football. We’re talking about people who make their money the old-fashioned way and try to keep it in the family, often for several generations. They see it as an heirloom to be passed down, not used up.

Just because people are rich doesn’t mean they are stupid. Old Money must have its secrets . . . its tricks . . . its wisdom, too. How do they do it? We’ve already revealed a couple of “secrets”: time and modesty. What other aces do they have up their sleeves?

We’re just finding out. We had no Old Money in our family. We inherited a few pieces of banged-up furniture from our mother, who inherited them from her father. That was it. What money we have now is so new the ink isn’t even dry yet. Should we spend it all ourselves? Should we retire to Florida too and wish the family good luck?